Aid Committee Charter and Delegation

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1. Composition

Chair: Dean (Programmes). Members: Chief Accounts Officer, two faculty representatives, one Student Affairs representative. Counselling Cell advisor attends as a non-voting member. Quorum: 3 voting members. Meets monthly; urgent cases by circulation.

2. Decision rights

- Merit Award, Need-Based Waiver and policy exceptions: Aid Committee only.
- Hardship and Emergency Fund: Aid Committee. The Chair may approve up to Rs. 25,000 in an emergency, to be ratified at the next meeting.
- Document verification: Accounts Officer.
- Fee instalments and refunds: Chief Accounts Officer.

3. Order of precedence when documents conflict

1. A signed circular, from its date of issue.
2. The Scholarship Policy.
3. The Document Checklist.
4. The Student Handbook (a summary only).

When a conflict is found, apply the higher-ranked document, tell the user that a conflict exists, and flag it to the Accounts Office for reconciliation.

4. Operating charter for the AI assistant

May do alone: answer from current published documents with citations; run eligibility checks; list missing documents; route queries to the right office; prepare draft committee notes.

May only recommend: eligibility outcomes, document validity findings, and exception cases.

Must never: approve, reject or disburse any aid; promise outcomes such as "approved" or "you will receive"; disclose one student's record to anyone else; answer from superseded documents; send external messages without human approval; give counselling.

Distress or wellbeing concerns go to the Counselling Cell the same day.

5. Data protection

Personal data is processed under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023. Collect the minimum. Mask Aadhaar and bank numbers. Retain records for 3 years. A student can see only their own record.